Pilot Support Materials Guide

Welcome to MAXLiteracy®! We're so excited to share this program with you and your students!

The **Write to Build Understanding** lessons in this program have been designed with a yearlong gradual release of responsibility from teacher to student. To support teachers who are picking up this program midyear, we have provided a set of targeted materials.

These materials are intended to help supplement some of the bedrock instruction that students would have experienced in the first few units of the program. They are not intended to replicate or reteach every lesson from the earlier units. Instead, they highlight the experiences that are most important to support a smooth transition into using MAXLiteracy.

Materials

Below is information about the different materials we are providing. For each material, we have explained its purpose, how to use it, and why it matters.

Writing Goals Poster

Grades 1–5



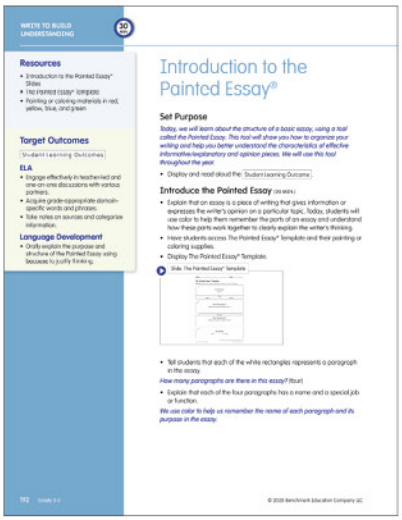
Purpose: In grades 1–5, throughout each instructional sequence, students set writing goals using the mnemonic of running a race. This helps them internalize the writing process and develop self-regulation strategies that support independence and persistence as writers. The Writing Goals Poster has been created for grades 1–5 pilot teachers. It is a reference material for teachers and students that can be referred to throughout the program.

How to use it: This poster should be displayed during writing time in all units to help students internalize the names and sequence of the goals associated with each part of the writing process. The poster can also be used to help students track where they are in the writing process for the specific writing piece they are working on.

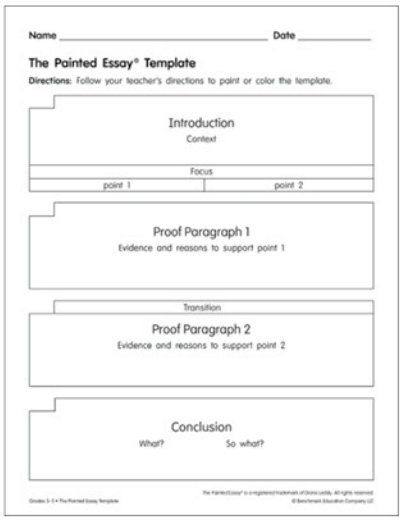
Why it matters: In MAXLiteracy, students are introduced to these process-based goals in the first half of the year with explicit instruction, guided practice, and self-reflection. In the second half of the year, students select individual goals, monitor their progress, and reflect on their growth as writers. When picking up the program midyear, teachers must introduce the goals when they first encounter them in the lessons. The poster supports students to learn and internalize the writing goals (and by default the steps of the writing process).

Introduction to the Painted Essay® Lesson and Slides and The Painted Essay® Template

Grades 3–5







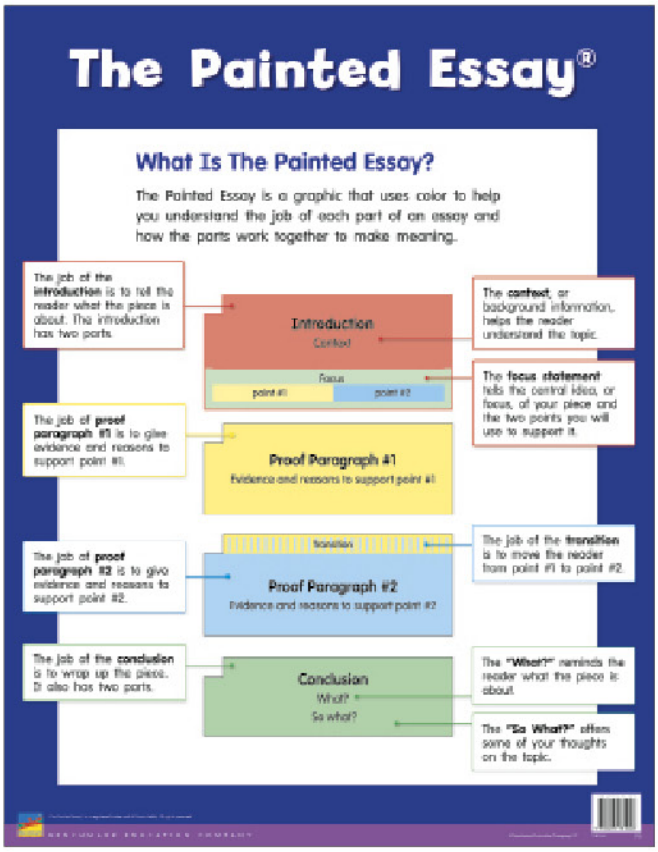
Purpose: In Unit 1 of grades 3–5, students are introduced to the Painted Essay. The Painted Essay is a tool that uses color to help students understand the relationship between purpose, organization, and evidence in expository writing (informative/explanatory writing and opinion writing). It is the **foundation for instruction** in these writing types.

How to use it: Before teaching any MAXLiteracy unit in grades 3–5, you must teach this lesson and have students paint or color their template.

Why it matters: These materials are critical because they **introduce the Painted Essay** — a tool that uses color to help students understand the key components of an effective expository writing piece and how they work together to make meaning. In this lesson, students learn the **consistent language** that is used throughout the program to describe the parts of the Painted Essay, the **colors** that go along with each part, and **each part's job**. This supports students in understanding standards-based concepts such as focusing a piece of writing, organizing information into paragraphs, and supporting their focus with evidence.

The Painted Essay Poster

Grades 3–5



Purpose: We created this poster for grades 3–5 pilot teachers to provide a reference material that teachers and students can refer to throughout the program.

How to use it: This poster should be displayed in a place where all students can access it during expository writing (informative/explanatory writing and opinion writing) sequences.

Why it matters: The poster helps teachers and students internalize the consistent colors and language that **anchor instruction in expository writing**.

Repeated experiences in attaching these colors to well-crafted written pieces deepens students' understanding of how text structure can be used to create meaning and helps them remember the key features of informative/explanatory writing and opinion writing. Internalizing this language and these concepts reduces cognitive load, allowing students to focus on the complexities of the specific writing piece they are working on.

Develop Language Slides (optional)

Grades 2–5









Purpose: These slides have been created as a resource to supplement sentence construction instruction **as needed**.

How to use it: Review the writing lesson for the day. Based on students' needs, teachers may choose to add these slides to their daily lesson deck to provide explicit direct instruction or a quick review of sentence construction skills.

If teachers want to provide explicit, direct instruction, they can use the instruction in the slide notes. Teachers should review the slide notes ahead of time and prepare any necessary writing materials (e.g., loose-leaf paper and pencils).

Why it matters: Students are provided with explicit instruction on sentence construction skills in Unit 1 of the program. Then, in subsequent units, students are prompted to use these skills as they draft their pieces. Based on what teachers have covered in the school year and their class data, they may want to use these slides to supplement sentence construction skill instruction. This supports students in applying these skills when they draft their pieces.

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